

Educational ads on Meta, from zero

We create over 500 ads a month for top DTC brands. The highest leverage skill we have is scripting ads that don't look like ads. Educational is the format that rewards it most, and the easiest to get wrong.

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Why educational ads fail

They fail when they sound like an ad pretending to be education. A guy holds up a supplement bottle and says "did you know magnesium plays a critical role in over 300 enzymatic reactions?" The viewer's ad-filter fires before a single word lands.

WHAT REAL EDUCATIONAL CONTENT HAS

Tension. It earns attention by doing three things a bottle-in-hand monologue never does:

- Challenges something the viewer assumed was true
- Shows them why what they are currently doing isn't working
- Hands them a piece of information they genuinely didn't have

An educational ad reads as boring for one of three reasons. The next page fixes all three.

WEAK

The insight is weak

WRONG

The format is wrong

MISMATCH

The messenger doesn't match

The 3 elements that make them work

1 A non-obvious insight at the core

Strong insights carry two things at once: specificity and a slight counter-intuitiveness. The audience wishes they had known it earlier, and now they want to know what to do about it. We pull these from our research process.

WORKED EXAMPLE

"Magnesium gets blocked by phytic acid in cereal grains, which is why 9 out of 10 people supplementing still feel deficient."

2 A format that doesn't broadcast "ad"

Any format that borrows from organic content buys the first 10 to 20 seconds of attention. From there the insight does the work. A talking-head selfie saying the same words fails because the ad-filter kicks in before the insight ever lands.

- Podcast-style
- Debate-style
- Spokesperson
- Expert VSL
- TikTok-style

3 A messenger that matches the message

Whoever is on screen needs a credible reason to be the one delivering this. When the messenger and the message line up, the ad holds. When they don't, the whole thing collapses.

- A clinician explaining biochemistry
- A founder breaking down product development
- A skeptic challenging an expert